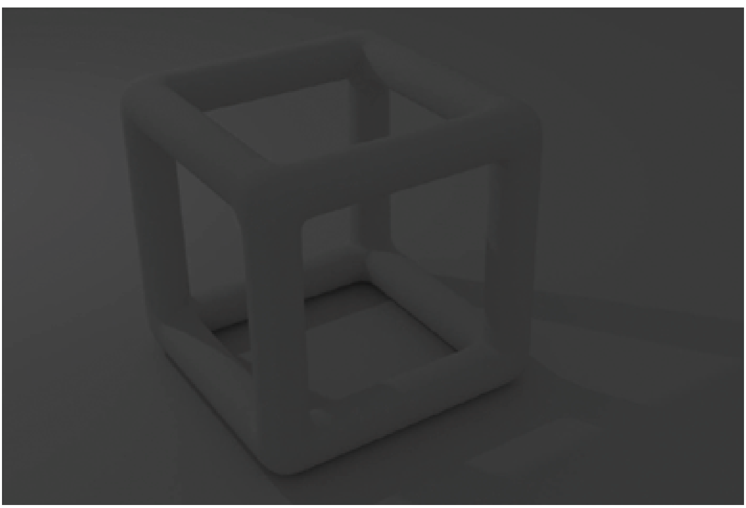
Initially, we have no lights in our scene. So what we get is only Ambient Light in our scene. When we render it, we get the result shown here. Quite clearly, an ambient scene is almost completely dark except a faint outline of the object. This is what we had learnt right. Ambient lighting is caused due to some faint vestiges of light in the room whose intensities have been greatly reduced due to multiple reflections from walls etc.

Now, let's see what difference diffused lighting brings to our scene. To add some diffused light to your scene, create a point light source (call it pointlight1) and add it at a location opposite to the render view. Remember how we said that the specular component of the reflected light depends on the view direction. Since we added pointlight1 at a position opposite to the view, the specular component will become close to zero and what we see will be diffused and ambient light.

Due to the diffuse light, now shadows cast by the object become visible. This is slightly better than our previous dark scene but it is still quite dark. Now we will add a point light near the "hollow cube" so that it illuminates the camera view of our object. When you render the scene, you will see the effect of specular lighting and there will be shiny white areas which will have a large specular component in the reflected light. Till now we have only used point lights in our scene. The issue with points lights is that they cast long shadows when only a few are present. There are still dark regions present in



Scene 2: Rendered in Ambient+Diffused Light in Cycles